

AFC Bank Product Innovation Strategy for Gen Z and Pensioners

Introduction

This document outlines a unified product strategy for AFC Bank targeting **Gen Z (18–35)** and **Pensioners** in Zimbabwe. The goal is to design banking services that are easy to implement, address clear customer pain points, and generate sustainable revenue for the bank.

The products focus on **transaction banking, ecosystem partnerships, and service differentiation**, rather than lending products, making them easier to deploy and scale.

SECTION 1: GEN Z PRODUCTS

1. AFC Young Hustler Account

Description

A low-fee digital transaction account designed for genz informal traders, freelancers, and gig workers operating in Zimbabwe's informal economy within the age threshold of **(18–35)**.

Unique Selling Point

Unlike traditional youth accounts, the Hustler Account is specifically designed as a **business transaction account for young informal entrepreneurs**, allowing them to manage business payments and collections easily.

How the Product Works

Customers open the account digitally using a national ID and mobile number. The account supports:

- Customer payments n- Supplier payments

- QR merchant payments

- Wallet transfers

The account acts as a **digital wallet for small businesses**.

Customer Benefits

- Easy digital account opening
- Low transaction fees
- Ability to manage small business payments
- Safer alternative to cash

Bank Benefits

- Rapid customer acquisition among youth
- Increased digital transactions
- Merchant payment ecosystem growth

Implementation Steps

- Configure Hustler Account in core banking system.
- Enable digital onboarding through mobile banking and USSD.
- Integrate wallet rails (ZIPIT, EcoCash, OneMoney, innbucks).
- Launch merchant QR payment acceptance.
- Introduce debit card issuance for Hustler accounts.

Financial Model

Revenue Streams:

- Transaction fees
- Merchant QR fees
- Debit card interchange

Projection:

Users: 50,000 Average transactions: 20/month Average per user fee: \$0.10

Annual revenue potential:

\$1.2M

2. AFC AgriStarter Kit (service)*

Description

A program designed to help young people enter agriculture through access to suppliers, advisory support, and agricultural marketplaces.

Unique Selling Point

Instead of focusing only on agricultural loans like competitors, AFC becomes an **agriculture ecosystem platform linking farmers, suppliers and buyers**. Young start up farmers.

How the Product Works

The program connects farmers to:

- Seed suppliers
- Fertilizer suppliers
- Agricultural advisory services
- Commodity buyers

Customer Benefits

- Easier entry into farming
- Reliable access to inputs
- Access to agricultural knowledge

Bank Benefits

- Positions AFC as the agriculture bank
- Increased agricultural transactions
- Supplier partnership revenue

Implementation Steps

- Build supplier partnerships with seed and fertilizer companies.

Integrate supplier payments through AFC accounts.

Launch advisory SMS farming alerts. Partner with agricultural cooperatives.

Financial Model

Revenue Streams:

Supplier commissions

Agricultural marketplace payments

Example:

10,000 farmers Average \$500 seasonal input purchase Commission 1%

Annual revenue potential:

\$50,000–\$150,000 initially

3. AFC Creator Wallet

Description

A multi-currency digital wallet designed for freelancers and creators receiving income from international platforms.

Unique Selling Point

The first Zimbabwe bank product designed specifically for the **creator economy and digital freelancers**.

How the Product Works

Users receive international payments and manage them locally through the wallet.

Features:

Multi-currency wallet

FX conversion

Debit card payments

Customer Benefits

Easier access to global income

Lower remittance fees

Ability to manage foreign currency earnings

Bank Benefits

Increased foreign currency deposits

Cross-border transaction revenue

Strong digital brand positioning

Implementation Steps

Find one big content creator

Enable multi-currency wallet accounts.

Partner with international payment networks. (stripe, paypal, visa)

Issue international debit cards.

Enable FX conversion in mobile app.

Financial Model

Revenue Streams:

FX spreads

International payment fees

Card interchange

Example projection:

20,000 users Average inflow \$500/month FX margin 1%

Annual revenue potential:

\$1.2M–\$2M

SECTION 2: PENSIONER

PRODUCTS

4. AFC Golden Years Account

Description

A zero-fee account designed specifically for pensioners.

Unique Selling Point

Provides the **most senior-friendly banking experience in Zimbabwe**, with simplified banking tools and priority service. (agrikat, additional services*)

How the Product Works

The account receives pension deposits and allows easy withdrawals and payments.

Customer Benefits

Reduced banking fees

Simplified banking access

Faster branch service

Bank Benefits

Stable deposit base

Strong community reputation

Multi-generational customer relationships

Implementation Steps

Configure pension account category.

Remove account maintenance fees.

Establish pension service desks in branches.

Launch simplified mobile interface.

Financial Model

Users: 30,000 Average balance: \$200

Deposit pool potential:

\$6M

Revenue through transactions:

\$200k–\$400k annually

5. AFC HealthShield Account

Description

A dedicated health savings account for pensioners.

Unique Selling Point

Combines banking with healthcare partnerships, creating the **first healthcare-focused banking account in Zimbabwe**. (bundle with health insurance services)

How the Product Works

Customers save funds in a dedicated health wallet and pay hospitals or pharmacies directly.

Customer Benefits

Better preparation for medical expenses

Healthcare partner discounts

Bank Benefits

Unique product differentiation

Strong customer loyalty

Long-term deposits

Implementation Steps

- Create health savings sub-account.
- Partner with hospitals and pharmacies.
- Enable direct provider payments.
- Market product through healthcare partners.

Financial Model

Users: 15,000 Average balance: \$100

Deposit pool:

\$1.5M

6. AFC Legacy Savings Plan (service)

Description

A savings product designed to help pensioners manage inheritance planning.

Unique Selling Point

Provides **estate planning tools for everyday customers**, not just wealthy clients.

How the Product Works

Customers assign beneficiaries and store estate documents securely.

Customer Benefits

- Clear inheritance planning
- Reduced family disputes

Bank Benefits

- Long-term savings deposits
- Multi-generational banking relationships

Implementation Steps

- Enable beneficiary management in account setup.

Partner with legal service providers.

Offer digital document storage.

Educate customers through retirement communities.

Financial Model

Users: 10,000 Average balance: \$500

Deposit pool potential:

\$5M

7. AFC Pension Advance (apply digital)

Description

A short-term loan facility allowing pensioners to access a portion of their upcoming pension payment when they need emergency liquidity.

Unique Selling Point

Unlike generic personal loans offered by other banks, the AFC Pension Advance is designed specifically around **pension payment cycles**, making it simpler and faster for pensioners to access small emergency funds.

How the Product Works

Eligible pension customers can request a small advance linked to their expected pension payment. The advance is automatically repaid when the next pension payment is deposited into the customer's AFC account.

Customer Benefits

Quick access to emergency funds

No complex loan application process

Automatic repayment from pension income

Bank Benefits

Predictable repayment linked to pension inflows

Increased pension account adoption

Additional fee income from service charges

Implementation Steps

Configure Pension Advance as a small credit product within the core banking system.

Link eligibility to verified pension inflows.

Enable request functionality through mobile banking and USSD.

Automate repayment deduction when pension payments are received.

Promote the service through pension associations and branch education programs.

Financial Model

Revenue Sources:

Small service fees

Interest margin on short-term advances

Example projection:

10,000 users Average advance \$100 Average fee \$5

Potential annual revenue:

\$500,000

Portfolio Impact

Product	Customers	Revenue Potential
Hustler Account	60,000	\$1M
Creator Wallet	20,000	\$1.5M
Golden Years	30,000	\$300k

HealthShield	15,000	\$100k
Legacy Plan	10,000	\$150k
Pension advance	100,000	\$500k

Total potential revenue:

\$3.5M+ annually

Conclusion

These products position AFC Bank as a **financial institution that supports both the emerging digital economy and Zimbabwe's aging population**, creating sustainable growth through innovative but practical banking solutions.